



INTELLIGENCE OFFICER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Intelligence officers protect their country from security threats and serious and organized crime, such as terrorism or human trafficking. They may use data-analysis skills to interpret intelligence from “sources”—people with access to sensitive information—about organizations or individuals who pose a risk to national security.



SALARY

Trainee ★★★★★

Senior officers ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Growing job sector due to heightened global security concerns • Cyber crime is a major area of growth • Option for working freelance

CAREER PATHS

To become a government intelligence officer, applicants must hold appropriate citizenship and pass a series of physical, psychological, and background checks. Your career path will depend on the skills for which you were recruited, but there is scope for specializing in particular areas—such as military intelligence—and progressing to senior roles in an agency.

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **CYBERSECURITY ANALYST** *see pp.132–133*
- ▶ **FORENSIC SCIENTIST** *see pp.146–147*
- ▶ **CRIMINAL INTELLIGENCE ANALYST** Examines crime data to investigate patterns in criminal activity, target individual offenders or gangs, and plan future crime-reduction initiatives.
- ▶ **CRYPTOLOGIST** Deciphers codes, puzzles, or cryptograms (puzzles that consist of a short piece of encrypted text), or creates them in order to protect private information.



GRADUATE You can apply to enter the intelligence service after earning your bachelor's degree in nearly any subject.



INTELLIGENCE OFFICER After a period of on-the-job training, you can serve in your first post for 18 months to three years. You can specialize in certain areas, or take a job rotation to another department or agency.